

Faculty To-Do Lists to Help Students Upskill with AI (CSU East Bay)

Department of Statistics & Data Science — CSU East Bay

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Table of contents

1 Purpose	1
2 Executive Summary of the Provost’s Vision	2
2.1 What the Provost Means by “Upskilling”	2
2.2 Three-Part Framework	2
3 Main Areas the Keynote Highlighted for Higher Education	2
4 Main Areas for the Future Job Market (CSUEB Students)	2
5 Faculty To-Do Lists by Area	3
6 References	3
7 Citations (from chat discussion)	3

1 Purpose

A concise, faculty-facing plan—derived from the Provost’s **Back to the Bay 2025** keynote—covering key ideas and concrete actions we can embed in Statistics and Data Science courses to **upskill** students.

Reference keynote: *Back to the Bay Keynote Script – AI + Workforce Development*, August 13–14, 2025. Office of Academic Affairs, CSU East Bay. (see **References**).

2 Executive Summary of the Provost's Vision

2.1 What the Provost Means by “Upskilling”

- Deliberately adding new capabilities and mindsets that prepare students to **apply knowledge in unfamiliar situations**—not just listing more skills on a résumé.
- Goal: Graduates who **learn quickly, communicate effectively, exercise judgment, and work across disciplines** in a world where **the only constant is change**.
- Motivation: AI is **redefining “entry-level”** work; employers expect more **complex, judgment-based** tasks earlier in careers. [Provost Keynote](#)

2.2 Three-Part Framework

1. **AI Fluency** — Understand how AI works, what it can and **cannot** do, and how to apply it **responsibly**. [Provost Keynote](#)
2. **Human-Centric Skills** — Empathy, ethics, communication, teamwork, leadership, and professionalism that **AI cannot replace**. [Provost Keynote](#)
3. **Agility** — The capacity to **adapt quickly** when conditions change and to course-correct with confidence. [Provost Keynote](#)

3 Main Areas the Keynote Highlighted for Higher Education

- **Demographic & trust headwinds** for higher education; we must **prove value** and improve student **readiness** earlier in the curriculum.
- **AI adoption in industry** is accelerating; “entry-level” expectations are moving toward **judgment, communication, and collaboration**.
- We must intentionally cultivate: **AI fluency, human-centric skills, and agility** across courses, co-curriculars, community projects, and research. [Provost Keynote](#)

4 Main Areas for the Future Job Market (CSUEB Students)

- Employers seek more than technical competence: **critical thinking, clear communication to diverse audiences, ethical judgment, collaboration with people and digital tools, professionalism, curiosity, and relational intelligence**.
- **Experience gap** matters as much as skills: students need **realistic, messy contexts** (people, deadlines, shifting priorities) to practice judgment. [Provost Keynote](#)

5 Faculty To-Do Lists by Area

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6 References

- Provost Muscat: *Back to the Bay Keynote Script – AI + Workforce Development (Aug 13–14, 2025)*. [PDF Link](#)
- CSU East Bay — [Statistics B.S.](#)
- CSU East Bay — [Statistics M.S.](#)
- CSU East Bay — [Data Science B.S.](#)

7 Citations (from chat discussion)

- “Upskilling” as deliberately adding new capabilities and mindsets so students can apply knowledge in unfamiliar situations (Provost keynote).
- Three-part framework: AI Fluency, Human-Centric Skills, and Agility (Provost keynote).
- Future job market emphasis: AI redefining entry-level roles; employers seek critical thinking, communication to varied audiences, collaboration with people and digital tools, ethical judgment, professionalism, curiosity, and relational intelligence (Provost keynote).